

Separate Tax Limitations Renewal Proposal – Informational Summary

On **Tuesday, August 4, 2026**, Oceana County voters will decide whether to renew the Separate Tax Limitations for Oceana County, its 16 townships, and the Intermediate School District (ISD) for an additional **10 years**, beginning with the County's July 1, 2027 tax levy and the townships' and ISD's December 1, 2027 tax levies.

If approved, the proposed **renewal** would **continue the current** separate tax limitations of **5.75 mills for the County, 1.25 mills for the townships, and 0.30 mill for the Intermediate School District** through 2036. The proposal would also restore the County's operating millage to its voter-approved level, which has been reduced over time due to the Headlee Amendment rollback provisions.

Property taxes provide approximately **61% of Oceana County's General Fund revenue** and are the primary local funding source for many County operations. General Fund revenues are used to support services such as the Circuit, District, and Probate Courts; Friend of the Court; Sheriff's Office, Jail, Road Patrol, Marine and Snowmobile Patrol; Prosecuting Attorney; Clerk, Treasurer, Register of Deeds, Equalization, and Tax Administration; Public Health; Emergency Management; Animal Control; Parks and Recreation; Planning Commission; Drain Commission; Veterans Services; Medical Examiner; Economic Development; and general county administration.

Some of these services are required by Michigan law, while others are authorized at the discretion of the Board of Commissioners based on available funding and community priorities.

For a home with a **taxable value of \$150,000**, restoring the County's operating millage from **5.6708 mills to 5.75 mills** was estimated to increase County property taxes by approximately **\$12 during the first year or \$1.00/month**. As with other operating millages, the authorized millage remains subject to applicable constitutional and statutory provisions, including future Headlee Amendment rollback calculations when required.

If approved, the Separate Tax Limitations would remain in effect for **10 years**. Any future increase above the voter-approved tax limitations would require approval by the voters.